Introduction

Delivering computing to young learners

Oxford International Primary and Lower Secondary Computing is a complete syllabus for computing education for ages 5–14 (Years 1–9). By following the program of learning set out in this series, teachers can feel reassured that their students have access to the computing skills and understanding that they need for their future education.

Find out more at:
www.oxfordprimary.com/computing.

Structure of the book

This book is divided into six chapters, for Year 3 (ages 7–8).

1. **The nature of technology:** Learning how digital devices can help
2. **Digital literacy:** Using technology to communicate
3. **Computational thinking:** Making a program with inputs and outputs
4. **Programming:** Setting and changing values to produce different outputs
5. **Multimedia:** Improving a slide show with text and images
6. **Numbers and data:** Using software to make calculations

What you will find in each unit

- Introduction: An offline activity and a class discussion help students to start thinking about the topic.
- Lessons: Six lessons guide students through activity-based learning.
- Check what you know: A test and activities allow you to measure students' progress.

What you will find in the lessons

Although each lesson is unique, they have common features: learning outcomes for each lesson are set out at the start; learning content delivers skills and develops understanding.


Activity Every lesson involves a learning activity for the students.


Extra challenge Activities to extend students who are able to do more.


Think again Questions check students' understanding of the lesson.

Additional features

You will also find these features throughout the book:


Word cloud The word cloud builds vocabulary by identifying key terms from the unit.


Be creative Suggestions for creative and artistic work.


Explore more Extra tasks that can be taken outside the classroom and into the home.


Digital citizen of the future Advice on using computers responsibly in life.

Glossary Key terms are identified in the text and defined in the glossary at the end.

Assessing student achievement

The final pages in each unit give an opportunity to assess student achievement.

- Developing: This acknowledges the achievement of students who find the content challenging but have made progress.
- Secure: Students have reached the level set out in the programme for their age group. Most should reach this level.
- Extended: This recognises the achievement of students who have developed above-average skills and understanding.

Questions and activities are colour-coded according to achievement level. Self-evaluation advice helps students to check their own progress.

Software to use

We recommend Scratch for writing programs at this age. For other lessons, teachers can use any suitable software, for example: Microsoft Office; Google Drive software; LibreOffice; any web browser.

Source files


You will see this symbol on some of the pages.

This means that there are extra files you can access to help with the learning activities. For example, Scratch programming files and downloadable images.

To access the files, click 'Download resources' at:
www.oxfordprimary.com/computing.

Teacher's Guides

For more on these topics, look at the Teacher's Guide that accompanies this book.